

Nintendo DS handheld

Sales of the Nintendo DS handheld have surpassed 50 million units in the US

PS3 will support 4k

Sony has announced the PS3 will get a firmware update around the beginning of 2012 which will support 4k stills

Online game purchase stores

There are many good reasons to buy boxed versions of a game — cheaper prices, no need to download huge amounts of data, and if you're into that, pretty little boxes to litter your shelves. But you sir, didn't buy that expensive gaming mouse just so you'd have to part its company for hours while you head to a store to buy your games. For you we present a few online shopping options for boxed games, where you can order games online and have them delivered to your house in a neat little package.

Flipkart.com

We're pretty sure you've all heard of this one, and although it's more popular for books, Flipkart does offer a decent collection of games for the PC and consoles. It has thousands of games across PC, PS2, PS3, Xbox-360, PSP, Wii, DS and 3DS. In addition it also sells consoles, console accessories and PC gaming accessories. Since the site already has a good customer base, you're likely to find reviews and ratings for many games.

The site is well designed and easy to browse based on game genre, price, availability, and format (whether it's for PC or console). Each game has screenshots (often of poor quality), links to the same game on other platforms, summary from the box, videos etc. Most games are available at a discount all the time.

If you've used Flipkart before, you're set! You can use your Flipkart account to buy games or even shop without an account. Creating an account simplifies the checkout procedure and allows you to maintain a wishlist on its site, which can be kept private or made public to share with friends.

Game4u.com

As the name of this store suggests, it's more tuned towards the needs of a gamer. Like Flipkart it offers both games and gaming equipment. Unfor-

tunately the selection of PC hardware is quite limited as it seems to have a tie-up with Razer and mostly only offer PC gaming equipment by them. It also seems to have a tie-up with EA although in this case it mostly means that it's a participating retailer in EA's contests.

Game4u offers games for numerous platforms – PC, PS2, PS3, PSP, Wii, Xbox 360, and DS. Its collection seems to be rather limited compared to Flipkart, however considering the number of 'out of stock' and otherwise unavailable products Flipkart lists, there might not be too much of a difference. One additional feature of Game4u is that it also sells and buys pre-owned games. If you don't play a console game anymore, you can trade it at the store for store credit, or you can purchase pre-owned games at a huge discounts.

Game4u occasionally has contests and numerous products have "deals" or discounts active at any given time. Like Flipkart, it too allows you to create an account for frequent purchases, or simply buy as a guest user.

Game4u has physical store locations as well – we thought it's worth a mention.

Intencity.in

Intencity is another online store that caters exclusively to gamers – well, almost exclusively, it has thrown in packages to Megaupload and Hotfile file-sharing services.

Here is another online retailer with a large pre-owned games collection for both Xbox 360 and PS3. It has games for PC, PS2, PS3, Xbox 360, PSP, Wii and DS. It seems to have a large collection, but not all listed games are in stock.

Unlike the above mentioned stores, Intencity makes it necessary to open an account in order to make purchases. The account lets you mark products as favourite, and you can even set price alerts for products – i.e. you get a mail if

their price drops. It even has a QuickOrder feature that lets you enter the name of the game directly rather than having to browse or search the store.

Unfortunately, while it lists a large number of games the availability of these games is quite poor. A large number of games are actually out of stock. It treats orders of out-of-stock games as pre-orders, where the game will ship when the game is available again, however it doesn't inspire much confidence. Also, it adds a service charge for paying via card. It really don't seem to be offering much of an advantage in anything except pre-owned games.

Nextworld.in

NextWorld offers many products other than games, but one look at the front page shows how gamer-centric the site is. The home page of the site is filled with information about featured games and gaming products, games for pre-order, which makes it hard to think this is anything but a gaming site – however it does offer numerous computer hardware and software products, media players and whatnots.

Nextworld has games for PC, PS2, PS3, Xbox 360, Wii, PSP, and surprisingly, also for the PS1. Nextworld is no different in that it has many games often available on discount.

Like Intencity, you need an account to purchase items. Apart from keeping your shipping address conveniently stored in your account, it also allows you to create lists of games, and more importantly create a watchlist that will inform you of price and availability changes. Best of all, it has a reward points system like GamersGate that gives you a certain amount back when you buy something from the site or post a review. As a welcome package, nextworld.in offers you 25 'reward points' which translates to ₹25 off on your first purchase – if you choose to of course. 